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A BLING STREET BEHIND BARRICADES

Metro Rail work on major corridors in Mylapore has cast a shadow on C.P. Koil Street with its goldsmiths **P4**



ART AGAINST DRUGS

Fevicryl-certified teachers fan out to educational institutions to create awareness about drug abuse and fight the scourge **P6**

Metro water supply hit at a few addresses in Mylapore



Repair works by CMWSSB being undertaken at K.P. South Street and Nallappan Street. PHOTOS: M. SRINATH

M. SRINATH

For three months now, there has been disruption in drinking water supply by Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board to certain parts of Mylapore, largely those coming under depot 124 of CMWSSB. By extension, these areas would be in Corporation ward 124. Complaints of unfilled sump for around three months have been pouring in from Arisikaran Street. Despite regular beeps on the mobiles of CMWSSB's depot 124 officials, the problem persists.

Not a drop of drinking water to our address in Arisikaran Street, says Diwakar, a resident of the street. Numerous complaints have been made; but the deadlock continues, he adds. CMWSSB has only dug-up trenches in front of some houses to show for their efforts; the pipelines are dry as a bone, says Diwakar.

The script is uncannily similar for some residents of K.P. South Street. Ramesh, a resident of K.P.



South Street, notes that after renovation of his house he went in for a new Metro Water connection and the mandatory meter, but the efforts are yet to yield piped water. Three months have elapsed and no drop of CMWSSB water in sight. Suresh, another resident on

KP South Street, points out lack of water supply caused him to suspect a problem in his sump. Acting on that thought, he changed the washer and other materials in the pump; and imagine his frustration to see the refurbished pump still being unyielding. Residents of Nal-

There are complaints about total lack of water supply as well as low pressure in the pipes

lappan Street, TSV Koil Street, Adam Street and Solaimariamman Street have also registered complaints about poor water supply by CMWSSB. Residents of these streets observe that despite a string of complaints, CMWSSB has not addressed the issue. While total lack of supply in some addresses persists, low pressure in pipelines is the sad reality in a few others. They note that since they are paying water tax diligently, they deserve better from CMWSSB.

Lalit Kala Akademi to host 'Contemporary Now'

Contemporary Now - Edition III will bring together India's leading galleries in a shared presentation of contemporary art from August 8 to 25.

This year's edition would span across 20 days with 66 artists at more than 10 venues in the city. Hosted by Lalit Kala Akademi, with partner programmes across the city, Contemporary Now presents a dynamic mix of exhibitions, panel discussions, artist walkthroughs, open houses, workshops and collector-focused engagements, making it one of the largest city-wide celebrations of contemporary art in South India, says a press release.

Built around the curatorial theme "Practices in Continuum: Tracing the Present", the exhibition invites audiences to engage with artistic practices that explore memory, identity, ecology, migration, politics, materiality and the evolving realities of our times.

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A grand lunch at Semmozhi Poonga marks a milestone



The event registering the 750th day of an ongoing annadanam initiative by Teynampet resident D.M. Prakash witnessed Thousand Lights MLA J.C.D. Prabhakar serving food to 150 of the nearly 1000 people who had the free meal

R. RAGU

On July 22, when this daily annadanam, a free mid-day meal initiative by Teynampet resident D.M. Prakash crossed a milestone, clocking 750 days on the trot, the food was understandably grander than on earlier days. Not only what was offered but how it was offered stood out. Imagine being served food by the MLA of the region: that is exactly what unfolded at the event for a good number of the beneficiaries, foot soldiers on the thoroughfare of life for whom a lunch that comes without a bill helps.

On regular days, food packets would be parked on a small table, and Prakash and his associates

would hand them over to the beneficiaries who would queue up. On the 750th day, many tables were placed in a straight line, and the beneficiaries were parked in front of them. Banana leaves were spread out before them. Volunteers were waiting on them hand and foot, running to fetch them the extra helping they sought. The venue, which on regular days would be the sidewalk on the road outside Prakash's house in Vellala Teynampet, had shifted to the Semmozhi Poonga, the parking area being marked for the event.

On the menu were chicken briyani with onion raitha, chicken 65, brinjal curry and bread halwa. (On regular days, a 'revolving menu', one following a weekly cycle would include vegetable briyani, coconut rice, lemon rice, pudhina rice, channa rice and Tomato rice.)

Prakash points out close to 1000 people partook of the celebratory repast. And 150 of those beneficiaries who settled down first for lunch had the food served by Thousand Lights MLA and Speaker of Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly J.C.D. Prabhakar.

The ongoing annadanam exercise by Prakash, an advocate who is carrying out this service with the support of his United States-based brother D.M. Suresh, benefits a diversity of foot soldiers: autorickshaw drivers, security personnel and daily wage earners.

READERS WRITE

Clocks not displaying correct time

R. KASIM RAZVI

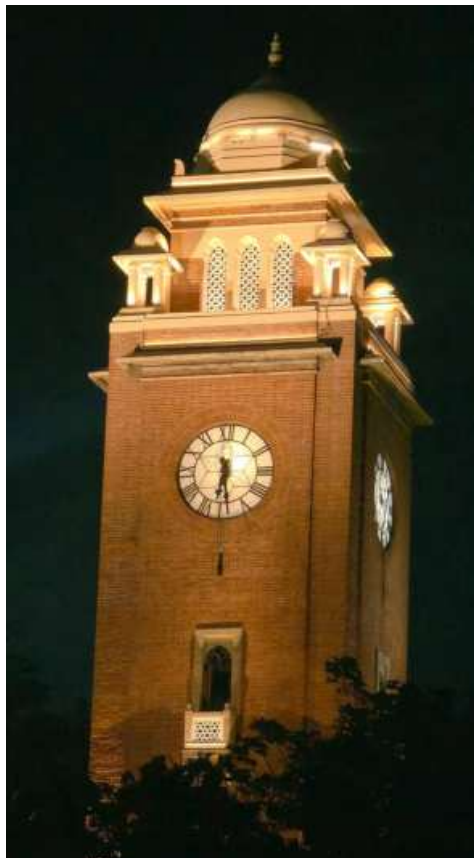
The historic clock towers at Presidency College and the University of Madras are important landmarks of Chennai's heritage. At times, these clocks stop functioning, and on many occasions, each of the four faces displays a different time, making them unreliable for the public.

The bell at the Presidency College clock tower also rings about ten minutes earlier than the actual time adding to the confusion. In addition, the Presidency College clock, which traditionally announced a Thirukkural along with its meaning, has remained silent in recent times, disappointing many visitors and heritage lovers.

In contrast, the historic clock tower at Anna University in Guindy is maintained well by its alumni association and consistently displays the correct time.

The authorities concerned should take immediate steps to restore and maintain the historic clocks at Presidency College and the University of Madras. The clocks should display the correct time on all four faces, the bell should ring at the proper time, and the Thirukkural announcement should be restored, preserving these iconic landmarks as symbols of Chennai's rich heritage.

R. Kasim Razvi is a resident of Mylapore



Unsafe flex banner at Santhome High Road junction

VANITHA VINODH

A massive flex banner has been raised near the junction of M.S. Viswanathan Salai and Santhome High Road, obstructing the view of motorists entering Santhome High Road. Drivers are unable to clearly see the traffic approaching from the right, creating a dangerous situation at this busy intersection.

The banner is also installed immediately adjacent to an electrical transformer, raising further safety concerns. Besides obstructing visibility, it distracts motorists, occupies public space and may pose a structural risk during adverse weather.

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay has repeatedly emphasised that public safety should not be compromised by roadside banners.

Vanitha is a resident of Santhome High Road



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Metro Rail work on major corridors in Mylapore has cast a shadow on C.P. Koil Street with its goldsmiths, and here is how these traditional craftspersons are ensuring the sparkle is not lost despite poor access to their doorsteps

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Chengazhuneer Pillaiyar Koil Street off North Mada Street in Mylapore can be missed by footwear-clad hooves other than those heading to it aware of what it has to offer, a standout craftsmanship nestling quietly inside. Narrow and hemmed in by non-decrepit buildings, it slips past the eye unless one has known it for what it is: the bling street in these parts. In terms of numbers, both of shops and transactions, C.P. Koil Street is no patch on Edapalayam Street, which winds like a necklace between NSC Bose Road in George Town and Walltax Road in Park Town. While Edapalayam Street is the undisputed capital for gold and other precious metal jewellery-making and testing in Chennai, C.P. Koil Street could be placed in a “family” that includes gold jewellery-making enclaves in T. Nagar and Purasawalkam.

The description of a lane fitting it better than that of a street, C.P. Koil Street (the quickly recognised contraction) is lined with shops of gold-and-other-precious-metal jewellery-making craftspersons strategically interspersed with those selling jewellery. There are flower vendors, and shops selling temple-related items at C.P. Koil Street sketching the classic image of a street running close to a famous temple (in this case, Kapaleeswarar temple), but the one trait that overrides everything else is that of a turf for craftspersons adept at shaping precious metal into wearables. These craftspersons, some of whom also work with silver and zari saris that have gold and silver threads woven into them, draw upon the trust built patiently over generations. At Santhosh Thanga Maligai, the owner M. Padmanabhan is carrying forward a family business that had its genesis on North Mada Street where his grandfather operated for nearly 50 years. In its current location at C.P. Koil Street, the business has weathered 40 summers. And if one does a simple addition math, there is an unmistakable and majestic hoariness to the enterprise. This account of a skill passed down generations is a recurring feature, the story reappearing at different addresses across C.P. Koil Street’s storefront.

A bling street behind barricades

This business cannot get any more family-oriented than it is. It could not be put more lucidly than how Karthik Gopal of Sagunthala Testing on C.P. Koil Street does. “It is a family business started by my grandfather Venkatesh,” and on who has been running it now, Karthik rattles off a list: “My father, me, my uncle, my aunt, my mother, my cousins, my niece... everyone” And that certainly is pretty much everyone in the family.

Just as craftsmanship and ownership are passed down the generations, on the other side of the counter, customer loyalty also follows an unbroken line of continuity, generations of a family getting gold jewellery done at a shop

whose work ethics they trust. This trust is coming in handy as these craftspersons are battling challenges arising from a mammoth civic work just beyond C.P. Koil Street’s doorsteps.

Finding itself in the long shadows of Metro rail work all around it, C.P. Koil Street might be a little less hoofed now, but the adverse situation has not significantly detracted from its glitter. The trust factor carries the day for these craftspersons as floating customers have dwindled on account of access unwittingly restricted by Metro rail work on main corridors in Mylapore, examples being Kutchery Road, Luz Church Road and RK Mutt Road.

“Now, almost all roads leading to the street have been affected by Metro rail work. Our regular customers still return because they know us,” says Karthik, noting that accessibility as a whole has been a difficult hurdle to bypass. Years of dedication and craftsmanship have earned them a loyal customer base. However, reputation alone cannot replace the steady stream of first-time visitors the place once enjoyed. “Seven years ago, there was much more footfall,” Karthik recalls. Being overly dependent on your established customer base with little scope for new customers swelling it can bring about a frustrating clinginess and a tendency to want to play Aladdin’s servile genie to those loyal customers from the past. Padmanabhan says his shop is open all days of the week, from 10.30 a.m. to 8.30 p.m.; and they close for work only on two festival days in a year. This challenge plonks alongside others faced by all goldsmiths, particularly those in south India, in Karthik’s view. While technology would have brought a cutting edge of accuracy and speed to the goldsmith’s job, Karthik notes, customers still prefer the sight of a goldsmith seated in front of them and testing and assessing the precious

In the run-up to Madras Day, a look at how a narrow, hidden street associated with a form of time-tested craftsmanship is holding on to its legacy against the backdrop of a civic work that has disrupted commerce in the region

metal. It is down to trust issues, he points out. Laser technology makes jewellery-making swift, but too many people cannot be allowed to stay around lest there could be spread of dust. Those who work with this technology are in the right gear for it. The challenge lies in making the process effective through technology and at the same time making it reassuringly visible for the customer.

A picture of sameness

“The street has not changed much,” says Karthik. Padmanabhan echoes that sentiment in a tone that rings wistful. “There has been no development. The street remains the same, and its narrowness leaves little scope for change,” says Padmanabhan. And perhaps that is what makes the present struggle so striking and relevant. The businesses remain where they started and the community they created continues to seek them. It is the journey moving forward that has become increasingly difficult for them. Preserving the place’s commercial character also means preserving the ease with which people, the outsiders, can be a part of it. And at present, that is a challenge.



A small number of apartment communities in Chennai now offer an impressive 1:1 EV charger-to-parking ratio thanks to developers future-focussed in their thinking. Even these developers admit they are on a learning curve, trying to grapple with technology to make their offering even more meaningful

Towards a fully 'charged up' parking space

LIFFY THOMAS

When a large apartment complex goes big on EV adoption, providing a dedicated charging point at every parking slot, the move will have far-reaching benefits. For one, it would give impetus to the Tamil Nadu government's October 2025 mandate requiring charging point for every individual car and two-wheeler parking space in residential buildings.

Here are two builders who saw the need for personalised charging points even before the State Government came up with this mandate.

In 2022-23, Radiance Group announced launch of the 234-unit Radiance Majestic in Valasaravakkam with one feature embossed: a one-to-one charger to parking ratio. Eight months ago when residents started occupying the flats, they were happy the builder had made good the promise.

The apartment complex has 10-15 EV owners who make the most of the single phase EV charging point that

delivers 7.4 kW of power when connected to their individual meter. This infrastructure is likely to get more residents to switch to an EV.

The builder is modest to admit they still have some ground to cover.

"We were inspired by projects in Pune and Mumbai to adopt the same in Chennai, but we are still learning as those owning a high end car want a fast charger but we have only provided a neutral charger. As this technology is still evolving, there is a lot that we need to analyse and factor in as more owners bring home an EV," says Gnana Murugan of Radiance Group.

With individual EV plug point at every parking spot, Lancor Infynys, a 290-flat gated community in Keelakattalai has a story of how the teething trouble was overcome. The irritants, which

included lack of output from the charging point, app not getting connected and iPhone not getting synced, were addressed over a period of time. "With technology do expect some issues but it is extremely easy and convenient to charge at your convenience from your own space," says Vinoth Kumar, who owns an electric two-wheeler.

He shifted from a large apartment complex in Pallikaranai to Keelakattalai a year ago to avail this facility. "My previous apartment did not have even a common charging point, so I used to go to public charging stations or borrow from other EV owners who had connected it from their power box," says Vinoth.

Those working in the EV charging network say it is way easier for an upcoming project to provide owners with the basic infrastructure at their parking lot by focusing on proper earthing and electric load capacity than initiating the work in existing apartments.

Nethaji M, senior manager, charging infrastructure at Bolt.Earth, an EV charging network, says all that we ask developers is provide the cabling work by connecting every parking lot

with the resident's individual meter. The charging kit varies from vehicle to vehicle and is provided when the person buys

the EV which can be fitted to the plug point.

"3.3 kW is the basic requirement that we recommend for an individual parking lot, but as the number of EV users increases in a community the extra load must also be planned by coordinating with the Tamil Nadu Electricity Board," says Nethaji.

CREDAI's stand

Confederation of Real Estate Developers Association of India - Chennai had represented to the Additional Chief Secretary, Housing and Urban Development Department, Government of Tamil Nadu that one-to-one charger-to-parking ratio may be "technically unnecessary, financially burdensome, and operationally impractical, especially in large residential developments."

Currently, 7 kW AC home charger has been used as the ba-

sis for EVs priced below ₹20 lakh. With the market fast moving towards 11 kW AC chargers, transitioning from 7 kW to 11 kW would reduce charging times by nearly 35%, sharply improving utilisation efficiency. If 11 kW becomes the norm, the current requirement of having a dedicated charger for every parking slot would result in an overcapacity, nearly 18 times higher, rendering the infrastructure severely underutilised, says CREDAI in their representation. Developers feel rapid technological advancements will outdate today's chargers. EV charging cables, often 30-40 mm in diameter, pose major challenges when routing hundreds of lines across basements and high-rise structures. The cumulative cable volume, ducting requirements, and heat considerations make one-to-one provisioning technically unviable.

A green upgrade, slow and steady

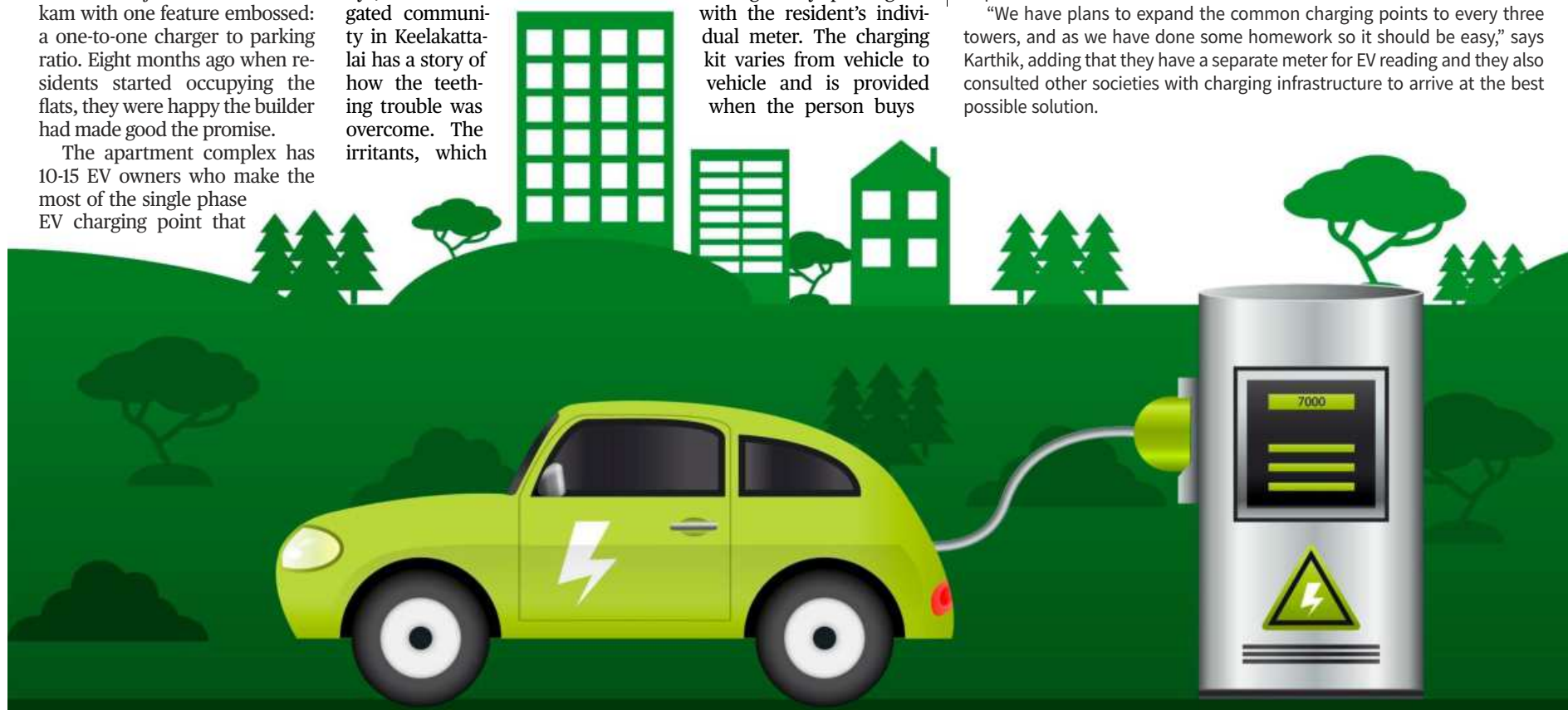
Most older gated communities are not keen on a one-to-one charger to parking ratio for a variety of reasons and are taking baby steps towards increasing the common EV infrastructure.

Brentwood, one of the 13 towers at House of Hiranandani in Egattur, was the first to invest in an EV charging station that was opened to residents from other towers as well. Now, they have another tower, Amalfi, that has also opened a charging station just for cars.

Likewise, DLF Gardencity Cluster 1 in Semmancherry invested in four basic charging devices to meet the needs of both two-and-four wheelers. The infrastructure was installed at a place easily accessible to residents from the nine towers at DLF Gardencity. This year, the Association upgraded the amenity with four charging points for two-wheelers and four others for four-wheelers.

Karthik T.S., a committee member, says their EV journey has been "steady and fruitful". Towards finding out what best suits the needs of the community, they took up a study that included finding out how many vehicles were coming to the community, how quickly the vehicles were getting charged, the EV capacity, the charger that should be used, how many charging stations are there around the campus and the power requirements.

"We have plans to expand the common charging points to every three towers, and as we have done some homework so it should be easy," says Karthik, adding that they have a separate meter for EV reading and they also consulted other societies with charging infrastructure to arrive at the best possible solution.





During a workshop at a college in Thiruverkadu. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Art against drugs

Fevicryl-certified teachers fan out to educational institutions to create awareness about drug abuse and fight the scourge

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

A city-wide campaign through art is mobilising students at colleges and schools to speak up about the dangers of substance abuse. Initiated by art and craft brand Fevicryl, the initiative launched recently has Fevicryl-certified teachers visiting institutions to conduct an art session where students use their creativity to create meaningful works on the theme of drug awareness. The sessions are aimed at encouraging creativity, building teamwork, promoting social responsibility and

creating awareness for a drug-free society.

Tejaswitha Singh, a resident of Adyar who is driving the initiative in south Chennai, says, "All what we ask institutions is give them two hours and at least 200 students and we engage with them to use art to create awareness." The materials for the artworks have to be arranged by the students that includes canvas board, markers and other stationery.

A team of three would be assigned to every institution where they are also involved in colouring a 6ft x 3 ft banner with colourful messages.

Besides being a Fevicryl certified trainer, Tejaswitha works as a guest lecturer in fashion designing. She says there are close to 150 such certified teachers in Chennai and they are fanning out to institutions in their respective areas to increase participation in this initiative.

By researching about drugs and its side effects to send out a message on canvas, the initiative nudges students to recognise behavioural signs and be allies with the State Government in combating the scourge of drug abuse.

If you wish to invite the team, contact Tejaswitha Singh at 80560 91498



A brush with acrylic painting

T. ARVIND

At 11, Hannah Maria Pradeep, a Class VI student of Bhavan's Rajaji Vidyashram in Kilpauk, is pursuing acrylic painting and portraiture while developing her artistic practice through formal training, exhibitions and participation in national and international art platforms. She is currently training at Dessin Academy partnered with The Tamil Nadu Dr. J. Jayalalitha Music and Fine Arts University, where she is learning acrylic and oil painting, portrait drawing, pencil sketching and pen sketching.

Artistic roots

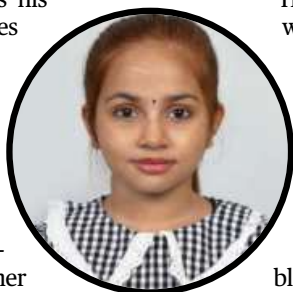
Her interest in art has been influenced by her late grandfather, Jerome Augustus Thomas, a classical artist known for his acrylic and oil paintings during the 1980s and 1990s. Although she did not have the opportunity to learn from him

A student of Bhavan's Rajaji Vidyashram is honing her skills in acrylic painting while drawing inspiration from a family legacy in art



directly, Hannah says his body of work continues to inspire her approach to painting. "Whenever I pick up a brush, I feel as though he is guiding my hand," says Hannah.

Acrylic is her preferred choice. One of her recent works, *The Last Whisper of the Forest*, depicts a young deer and reflects themes of wildlife conservation and environmental awareness.



Hannah's paintings were exhibited at *Colourful Expressions 2025*, the annual exhibition organised by Dessin Academy, where works by students were displayed before members of the public and the art community.

She also secured the first place in the Upper Primary category of A Virtual Cultural Extravaganza, organised by I2OR India in collabora-



Hannah Maria Pradeep's works in acrylic. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

theme India Through My Eyes, which focussed on India's cultural heritage and environmental consciousness.

She is also a member of the Children's Art Museum of India and is currently participating in The Giant Hunt, an all-India anime competition associated with a Guinness World Record attempt involving thousands of young participants.

Asked about her artistic journey, Hannah Maria Pradeep said: "I believe every child is born with a special gift. Mine is art. I am thankful to my parents and teachers for encouraging me to pursue my passion and helping me develop my skills."

Hannah's mother, Swetha Margaret, an educationist, said encouraging her daughter to pursue art has helped her develop interests beyond academics. "Her interest in art has complemented her academic performance. While education is important, parents should also identify their children's talents and support them in pursuing their interests."

tion with Green ThinkerZ India. In another achievement, she was selected as a Star Artist in Artistic Genesis 2026, an international art event that drew entries from more than 1,200 artists representing 61 countries. According to the organisers, the entries were assessed by an international jury comprising artists from Canada, Egypt and India.

Hannah has participated in The Indian Art Fest, an international platform for young artists, and contributed artwork to the Art for Awareness campaign under the

PLAN YOUR WEEK

Inviting married women for 'Face of Chennai'

Registrations have opened for the 15th edition of IRIS Face of Chennai - Mrs Category. Married women up to the age of 50 years from diverse backgrounds can participate to showcase their personality, talents, and unique journeys. Participants will gain access to expert mentoring, grooming and presentation training, networking opportunities, exciting gifts, and a platform to enhance their confidence and skills.

To register for auditions, contact 98847 83510, 98412 06506



Two-day convention on Vedas

Om Charitable Trust will be hosting its 18th annual two-day convention called "National Vedic Talent Vista 2026." The event will be held on August 1 and 2 at Sri Krishnaswamy hall, No.62, South Boag Road, T. Nagar.

According to a press release, the event aims to honour Vedic scholars who have cleared the rigorous Vedic examinations conducted by the Om Charitable Trust.

Lectures on Vedas, quiz, chanting of Vedas, and cultural events are part of the programme, adds the release. Om Charitable Trust is at No: 49, Five Furlong Road, Guindy. Phone: 95661 95611 / 91766 91111

Dance workshop by Lester Fernandes on August 1

Noted choreographer Lester Fernandes will be conducting a dance educator in the city on August 1.

Lester shot to fame as a child artiste in Bollywood, where he danced alongside Shah Rukh Khan and Madhuri Dixit in Chak Dhoom Dhoom. Over the years, he became an integral part of the Shiamak Davar Dance Company.

Lester will conduct three exclusive workshops at Fitness & Beyond by Hanny, a contemporary fitness and wellness studio on Flowers Road in Kilpauk.

The day will see a Bollywood workshop for children, followed by a session for adults and conclude with a garba session. The event has been curated by Sheetal Rayathatha and Rishika Pawany.

For details, call 7984556577

Course on Montessori teacher training

The Indian Montessori Training Courses (IMTC), Chennai, will commence their 57th Montessori teacher training Course in August.

The weekend course will have online and in-person sessions, a format designed to suit working women, enabling them to balance work and family while pursuing their passion for early childhood education.

IMTC-Chennai is affiliated with the Indian Montessori Center, Bengaluru, which awards the Diploma to successful candidates.

IMTC-Chennai has trained more than 1700 teachers, and over 45 schools in Tamil Nadu have been established by the institution's alumni. For details, WhatsApp and call 94449 36263, 044-24614301.

Inclusive arts to take centre stage at IIT-M on August 2

Can inclusivity be celebrated through art, music and dance? It can - if you were to look at 'Aavaa Dingi', an initiative to empower and develop the underprivileged and economically challenged youth and differently-abled people through workshops, fine arts and cultural performances.

According to a press release, part of the sustainable development project for DCF Global Inclusive Town vision, 'Aavaa Dingi' will witness international inclusive music and dance teams collaborating with local artistes and differently-abled talent to showcase their talent and inspire the world.

After successful drawing/painting and singing competitions earlier this month, the festival heads for a grand celebration on August 2.

The 2026 line-up includes some exciting performances. Apart from inclusive music and dance performances, it will also give away awards in multiple categories. Columbian singer Evelyn Soto, who regularly tours with AR Rahman, will perform at the event. In addition, the performance will include the inclusive band VFU (Voice for Unity - The DCF Band), comprising 20+ specially talented children, says the press release.

The event will also be supported in person by celebrities such as popular music composer James Vasanthan, singers Vaikom Vijayalakshmi and Anuradha Sriram.

'Aava Dingi 2026' will take place on August 2, 5 p.m. onwards at Open Air Theatre (OAT), IIT Madras. To register, log on to www.aavaadingi.com

Amma canteen at Omandurar GH sought

Members of Rajiv Gandhi Nagar Youth Welfare Association in Semmencheri have written a letter to the State government seeking the establishment of an Amma Unavagam (canteen) on the premises of the Tamil Nadu Government Multi Super Speciality Hospital at Omandurar Government Estate.



S. Jayakumar Sekar, a core member of the Association, says, "Every day, the hospital receives many patients and caretakers from various parts of Tamil Nadu. However, there is no affordable food facility within walking distance of the hospital." It is common to see attenders walking till Wallajah Road and nearby areas to buy food for patients.

The Amma Unavagam facilities close to the hospital are located approximately 1.5 kilometres away (Arunachalam Road and West Coovam River Road in Chintadripet), making it difficult for those accompanying patients.

Although a restaurant is available at the nearby MLA's Hostel, the prices are beyond the reach of many poor and middle-income families.

The representation was also submitted to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay (Chief Minister's Special Cell), the Health and Family Welfare Department and the hospital administration, requesting establishment of a canteen within the hospital campus, he added.

Text: T.S. Atul Swaminathan

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Rallying for our wetlands



C. NAMACHIVAYAM

A staggeringly huge number of organisations united by their interest in conservation of natural habitats organised a protest march at Besant Nagar Beach on July 25,

highlighting the destruction of wetlands in south Chennai.

One of the salient features of the march was the eye-catching props used by the protestors. The props included a life-size representation of a flamingo demanding that people stay off its turf.

Others included images of fish that people wear while holding placards.

The organisations that participated in the protest march are: Alliance of Residents Welfare Associations; Agai, The Theater of Voices; Chennai Climate Action Group;



Images from the rally.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Chennai Wetlands Action Collective; Center for Financial Accountability; Chitlapakkam Rising Team; Foundation for Friendly En-

vironment and Medical Awareness; Federation of Perumbakkam Resident Welfare Associations; Federation of Old Mahabalipuram Road Resident Associations; Friday For Future Chennai; Palluyir Trust; Ramapuram - Youth Climate Resilience Movement; Reached the Unreached; Saving Nanmangalam Lake Team; Singaravelar Padipagam; SPARK; Suzhal Arivom; Tambaram Makkal Kuzhu; Uvakai Research Foundation; Vettiver Collective; Visai; Vinaa Naadaga Kuzhu; Vyasarpadi - Youth Climate Resilient Movement; and Zenith Learning Center.

HGI starts school in Padappai



The Hindustan Group of Institutions (HGI) has established Hindustan International School (HIS) in Padappai to provide a contemporary learning environment that integrates academic excellence, technology, creativity, sports, and values-based education.

Theodosius Mar Thoma, Metro-

politan, Malankara Mar Thoma Syrian Church, inaugurated the campus.

In his speech, he underscored the importance of education rooted in values, character, and compassion in shaping responsible global citizens.

Anand Jacob Verghese, chairman of Hindustan Group of Insti-

tutions, said, "We believe education must go beyond academic achievement to nurture character, creativity, critical thinking and a sense of purpose. Through this campus, we aim to create an environment where every learner is encouraged to explore their potential, embrace innovation and grow into a responsible global citizen while remaining rooted in strong values."

The campus features smart classrooms, robotics and computer laboratories, composite science laboratories, innovation and maker spaces, and dedicated sports infrastructure.

Two books were released: one curated by Anand Jacob, 'Journey of Parables', a collection of reflections centred on leadership and values, and a coffee table book, 'Historia', documenting the decade-long journey of Hindustan International School, a release from HGI stated.

DG Vaishnav College wins basketball title



The Dwaraka Doss Goverdhan Doss Vaishnav College (Autonomous) won the 29th Sree Raghavendra Inter-Collegiate Basketball Championship, held in the city from July 11 to 23.

In the knockout match, the college defeated Jeppiaar University, 72-47; in league matches, SRM University, 67-56; Hindustan University, 71-69; and Madras Christian

College, 91-51. The team showed outstanding teamwork, which paved the way for an unbeaten run in the tournament and helped them to clinch the title and bring pride to the institution.

The results: Hindustan University, runner-up; SRM University, third place; and Madras Christian College, fourth place, said a release.

Health camp conducted

A health checkup camp was held at the Divisional office of The New India Assurance Company Ltd at Bombay Mutual Building in Parrys on July 22 to celebrate its 108th Foundation Day. R. Jayashree, divisional manager, inaugurated the camp for the field workers and customers.

Family Health Plan Insurance TPA Ltd.(FHPL) coordinated the camp with a team of doctors from Kavery Hospital to takes up various tests. A team from Agarwal Eye Hospital and doctors from Clove dental hospital were conducted screening at the camp.

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